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Advantage/Disadvantage Essays

How to identify advantage/disadvantage essays

Statement + Question

In many countries, parents are deciding to have children later in their lives.
Do you think the advantages of this development outweigh the disadvantages? (or)
Is this a positive or negative development? (or)
Do the advantages of this development for the parents outweigh the disadvantages for the children? ***(this question is tricky because you have to talk about the advantages for the parents and the disadvantages for the children)***

Essay Structure

70/30 Structure

For Advantage/ Disadvantage essays, it's a good idea to mention both advantages and disadvantages and then show which side you agree with. For this, you can use the 70/30 structure.

Introduction

- *Introduce the topic*
- *Respond to the question*

Body Paragraph 1 (1 disadvantage)

- *Topic sentence*
- *Development*
- *(Link)*

Body Paragraph 2 (2 advantages)

- *Topic sentence (advantage 1)*
- *Development (advantage 1)*
- *(Link) (advantage 1)*
- *Topic sentence (advantage 2)*
- *Development (advantage 2)*
- *(Link) (advantage 2)*

Conclusion

- *Restate position*
- *Summarise ideas*

You can use this structure for when you think the advantages are greater than the disadvantages or vice-versa. For example, if you think the disadvantages are greater, present 1 advantages in body paragraph 1 and 2 disadvantages in body paragraph 2.

For more information on how to write an introduction, body paragraph, or conclusion, go to the lesson on each of these parts in the course.

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In many countries, parents are deciding to have children later in their lives. Do you think the advantages of this development outweigh the disadvantages?

70/30 Structure

Introduction
- *Introduce the topic*
- *Respond to the question*

Body Paragraph 1
- *Topic sentence*
- *Development*
- *(Link)*

Body Paragraph 2
- *Topic sentence*
- *Development*
- *(Link)*
- *Topic sentence*
- *Development*
- *(Link)*

Conclusion
- *Restate position*
- *Summarise ideas*

In the past, it was common for couples to settle down and have children in their early twenties. Nowadays, many are waiting until their thirties or later to start a family. Despite potentially being more difficult to form close relationships with their children, I would argue that having children at a later age is more advantageous as parents tend to be more financially and emotionally prepared to start a family.

Those that claim the disadvantages of having children later in life point to the benefits of having youthful parents. It is often easier for children to have closer relationships with parents who are not too distant in age. This is true on a psychological and physical level: psychologically, younger parents are more likely to have shared interests while physically, younger parents have more energy for playing games and sports with their children. Hence, in the interest of having a closer relationship with their children, many parent's choose to have children earlier.

However, I would argue that there are more advantages of having children later in life. Firstly, mature parents are usually in a better financial position and are therefore better able to cater to their child's needs: schooling, excursions, activities, etc. In contrast, younger parents are less likely to be established in their careers and may not have the financial means to provide for their children. Secondly, older parents are also usually more emotionally stable and wise. This creates a more steady and peaceful upbringing for their offspring, as well as a store of knowledge and wisdom, which can be used to guide their children. The better prepared the parent's are, the easier it will be to raise a family.

To conclude, while I acknowledge that having children earlier has certain advantages in terms of physical and psychological bonding, I would assert that, because of the financial and emotional stability that older parents have, the advantages of having children later in life outweigh the disadvantages.

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Advantage/ Disadvantage Practice Questions

Nowadays, many physical retail shops (such as clothing stores) are being replaced by online shops.
Is this a positive or negative development?

In many counties, young people are choosing to go to universities abroad rather than studying locally.
Is this a positive or negative development?

These days, more and more people are going to other countries for significant periods of time, either to find a job or to study.
Do the advantages of living in a foreign country outweigh the disadvantages?

Nowadays, many people are able to work from home.
Do the advantages of working from home outweigh the disadvantages?

It is a common aspiration among many young people to run their own business, rather than work for an employer.
Do you think the advantages of working for yourself outweigh the drawbacks?

In some areas, money earned from tourism has become an integral part of the local economy.
Do the advantages of relying on tourism as a major source of revenue and job creation outweigh the possible disadvantages?

Schools in some countries require their students to wear a uniform.
Do you think the advantages of having a school uniform outweigh the disadvantages?

As countries develop, more people are able to purchase a car.
Do you think that the advantages for the individual outweigh the disadvantages for the environment?



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